



The 7-Day Reset

A complete mind-body recovery protocol — nervous system regulation, food-as-medicine, mind renewal, and measurable healing in 7 days

Dr. Vera Holloway, CNS + CHN · Your Health Matters

This is not a diet. This is not a wellness trend.

This is a 7-day clinical protocol designed to reset your nervous system, restore insulin sensitivity, retrain your perception, and prove biologically that your body can heal when given the right inputs. Every day builds on the previous. Every protocol is measurable. You will see changes by Day 2 — confirmed by wearable data, heart rate, sleep quality, and how you feel. By Day 7 you will have built a foundation you can return to for the rest of your life.

OVERALL ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED

MARKER	DAY 1 BASELINE	DAY 7 TARGET
Resting Heart Rate	Your starting BPM	Drop 5-15 BPM
Sleep Duration	Whatever you average now	7-8 hours consistent
Sleep Quality (Deep + REM)	Track Day 1 with wearable	20%+ deep · 20%+ REM
Morning Energy	Rate 1-10 honestly	Increase 2-3 points
Anxiety Wave Frequency	Count Day 1 waves	Reduce 30%+
Digestion + Bowel Movements	Note baseline pattern	Daily + formed
Stable Blood Sugar	Notice crashes + cravings	No 3pm crash
HRV (if measured)	Wearable baseline	Increase 10-30%

THE FOUNDATION — THE RULES THAT RUN EVERY DAY

Before the daily protocols — the structural foundation. Every meal, every drink, every food decision across all 7 days happens inside this framework. Master this once. It applies forever.

1 · THE FOUR INSULIN TIME ZONES

PEAK	DECLINING	CAUTION	AVOID
6am – 2pm	2pm – 6pm	6pm – 9pm	9pm – 6am
All meals, fruits, juices, carbs. 9-10am is the optimal window.	Low-sugar vegetables + protein + fat only. No fruit juice. No grains.	Light dinner only. Vegetable juice OK. No carbs. No fruit.	Water + herbal tea only. Kitchen closes 7pm. 12-16 hr overnight fast.

2 · THE EATING SEQUENCE — NEVER CHANGES

1  FIBER FIRST Vegetables raw or cooked · Fiber barrier reduces glucose spike 30-40%	2  PROTEIN SECOND Eggs, fish, meat, yogurt · Triggers GLP-1 · zero glycemic impact	3  FATS THIRD Avocado, EVOO, nuts · Unlocks fat-soluble nutrient absorption	4  CARBS LAST Quinoa, fruit, grains · Arrives to fully buffered digestive system
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3 · PORTIONS + HYDRATION BASELINE

■ Plate Portions

Half plate vegetables · quarter plate protein (palm-size) · quarter plate complex carb (cupped hand) · 1 tbsp healthy fat. Eat slowly. Stop at 80% full.

■ Daily Hydration

Half your body weight in ounces of water minimum. Body 150 lbs = 75oz water. Morning starts with 16oz water + sea salt + lemon. Sip throughout day.

■ Morning Sequence

Lemon water + salt (wait 15 min) → beet juice (wait 5 min) → cinnamon water (wait 10 min) → breakfast in correct order. This is THE sequence.

■ Post-Meal Walk

10 minutes after every meal. Drives glucose into muscles independent of insulin. Reduces post-meal spike 15-20%. Non-negotiable.

DAY 1

FOUNDATION + HYDRATION RESET

"Stop the noise. Start the input."

Why this day matters

Day 1 is about creating space. You stop the inputs that have been feeding the cycle and you introduce the inputs that will reverse it. The body cannot heal with the same conditions that created the problem. Today changes the conditions.

■ Morning

6-7am · 16oz water + sea salt + lemon (sip slowly) · 4-7-8 breathing 4 cycles · Cold water face splash 30 sec · Eggs + spinach + avocado · Take baseline wearable readings

■ Midday

Peak Zone lunch — salad first, then protein (fish or chicken), then healthy fat, then quinoa or sweet potato · 10-minute walk after · Switch to herbal tea only

■ Evening

6pm dinner — vegetables + lean protein only, NO carbs · Kitchen closes 7pm · No screens after 9pm · Magnesium glycinate 400mg at 9:30pm · In bed by 10:30pm

■ Mind Practice

Thought Sorting — categorize first 3 waking thoughts as Fact, Story, or Worry. Begin building the gap between thought and reaction.

■ FOODS TODAY

Whole eggs · spinach · avocado · wild salmon · chicken · quinoa · sweet potato · blueberries · pumpkin seeds · EVOO · lemon · sea salt

■ AVOID

Caffeine after noon · alcohol · processed food · refined sugar · seed oils · news · social media after 7pm

■ TRACK

Resting HR (morning) · sleep quantity · sleep quality · energy level 1-10 · digestion · anxiety wave count

✓ **ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — How You Know You Completed Day 1**

- Drank 64+ oz water today
- Ate in correct sequence at least 2 meals
- Kitchen closed by 7pm
- In bed before 11pm
- Took magnesium before sleep
- No screens 30 min before bed

■ **What we don't often think about**

Mouth breathing alone keeps you in sympathetic mode. Tape your mouth at night with mouth tape or simply notice nose breathing during the day. The shift from mouth to nose breathing alone can drop resting HR 3-5 BPM within days.

NERVOUS SYSTEM REGULATION

"Tone the vagus nerve. Activate the brake."

Why this day matters

Day 2 builds vagal tone — the parasympathetic nervous system's ability to slow you down. Your sympathetic system has been over-trained. Today you train its opposite. Every practice today directly activates the vagus nerve which controls heart rate, digestion, immune function, and emotional regulation.

■ Morning

Same morning sequence as Day 1 · ADD 5 minutes humming or singing in the shower (vagal activation) · ADD gargling cold water for 30 seconds after teeth brushing

■ Midday

Cucumber + celery juice mid-morning · Peak Zone lunch with eating sequence · 15-minute walk OUTSIDE (peripheral vision activates parasympathetic) · No screens during lunch

■ Evening

Vegetable soup + protein dinner · Warm bone broth before bed · Magnesium glycinate 400mg · 10 minutes of slow exhale breathing (longer exhale than inhale) · Sleep by 10:30pm

■ Mind Practice

Body Scan — every 2 hours, pause 60 seconds. Drop shoulders. Unclench jaw. Soften belly. Notice where you hold tension. Builds interoception.

■ FOODS TODAY

Bone broth · fatty fish · fermented foods (sauerkraut, kimchi, kefir) · leafy greens · pumpkin seeds · cucumber · celery · warm cooked vegetables

■ AVOID

Cold smoothies (cold dampens digestive vagal tone) · rushed eating · eating while scrolling · multitasking during meals

■ TRACK

Heart rate variability (if available) · how many vagal practices completed · tension level 1-10 before/after walks

✓ **ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — How You Know You Completed Day 2**

- Completed humming or gargling practice
- Took at least one outdoor walk
- Ate one fermented food serving
- Did body scan at least 3 times
- No phone during any meal
- Slept 7+ hours

■ **What we don't often think about**

Your eyes affect your nervous system more than you know. Looking at screens (tunnel vision) keeps you in sympathetic mode. Looking at distant objects and panoramic views (peripheral vision) activates parasympathetic. Every 30 minutes — look at the horizon or out a window for 30 seconds. This alone reduces stress measurably.

DAY 3

MOVEMENT + NATURE

"Move the body. Reset the system."

Why this day matters

Day 3 introduces strategic movement. Not exercise as punishment. Movement as medicine. Aerobic activity strengthens the heart so it needs fewer beats to do the same work. Time outside drops cortisol 15-20% measurably. Both happen today.

■ Morning

Same morning sequence · ADD 20-30 minute brisk walk outside before breakfast (fasted state walking burns fat + lowers insulin) · Sunlight on face for 10 minutes (resets circadian rhythm)

■ Midday

Peak Zone lunch · 15-minute walk after eating · Mid-afternoon 5-minute stretch break · Switch to walking meetings if possible

■ Evening

Light dinner · 20-minute slow walk after dinner (digestion support) · Gentle stretching or yoga before bed · No intense exercise within 3 hours of sleep

■ Mind Practice

Reset Walk — one walk today with no phone, no podcast, no music. Just walking. Notice trees, sky, distance. Attention restoration is real medicine.

■ FOODS TODAY

Same Peak Zone foods · ADD electrolytes (sodium + potassium + magnesium) during/after walks · Watermelon, oranges, coconut water if exercising harder

■ AVOID

High-intensity workouts (your nervous system is still recovering) · long sedentary stretches over 90 minutes · exercising in poor air quality

■ TRACK

Steps · minutes outside · resting HR change from Day 1 · how movement felt 1-10

✓ **ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — How You Know You Completed Day 3**

- Logged at least 5,000 steps
- At least 30 minutes outside
- No phone during one walk
- Did post-meal walks after lunch + dinner
- Stretched at least once
- Slept 7+ hours

■ **What we don't often think about**

Light exposure timing is medicine. Morning sunlight within the first hour of waking sets your cortisol curve correctly for the entire day. Evening artificial light AFTER sunset suppresses melatonin. Get sunlight in the morning. Dim your lights after 8pm. This single shift improves sleep quality more than most supplements.

NUTRITION OPTIMIZATION

"Feed the systems that heal you."

Why this day matters

Day 4 zooms into food specificity. Your nervous system, your gut, your liver — each requires specific nutrients to function. Today you intentionally feed each one. Magnesium, omega-3, B-vitamins, choline, polyphenols. Targeted nutrition is targeted medicine.

■ Morning

Add greens to breakfast (spinach, kale, arugula in eggs) · 16oz beet + celery juice · Eggs (choline for liver) · Pumpkin seeds on yogurt (magnesium + zinc) · Avocado (potassium + healthy fat)

■ Midday

Wild salmon lunch (omega-3) · Mixed leafy greens (folate + B vitamins) · Olive oil + lemon dressing (polyphenols) · Sweet potato or quinoa · Berries for dessert (anthocyanins)

■ Evening

Bone broth-based soup with vegetables · Lean protein · Fermented food (1 tbsp sauerkraut or kimchi) · Pumpkin seeds before bed (tryptophan + magnesium)

■ Mind Practice

Single-Tasking Meal — one meal today with zero distractions. No phone. No screens. No work. Just eating. Notice flavors, textures, temperature. Activates parasympathetic digestion.

■ FOODS TODAY

Wild salmon · sardines · pumpkin seeds · walnuts · spinach · arugula · beets · eggs · avocado · blueberries · turmeric + black pepper · ginger · garlic · EVOO · sauerkraut

■ AVOID

Anything you cannot identify the source of · ultra-processed packaged foods · vegetable oils · artificial sweeteners · sodas (regular AND diet) · skipped meals

■ TRACK

Number of organ-system foods consumed · digestion 1-10 · energy after meals 1-10 · cravings 1-10

✓ ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — How You Know You Completed Day 4

- Ate fatty fish OR took fish oil 1200mg
- Ate leafy greens twice
- One fermented food serving
- No processed foods today
- Ate one meal completely undistracted
- Drank 64+ oz water

■ What we don't often think about

Hunger spikes cortisol. Going too long without eating triggers the same stress cascade as a worry-thought — your amygdala interprets low blood sugar as a survival threat. Skipping meals to "save calories" is not discipline. It is biological self-sabotage. Eat consistently in the right zones.

MIND RENEWAL DAY

"Train the lens. Renew the perception."

Why this day matters

Day 5 turns the lens inward. By now your body is repairing. Today you begin renewing the mind that drives the body. Every chronic stress disease has its origin in untrained perception. Today you train it. This is where the rewiring becomes permanent.

■ Morning

Same morning sequence · ADD 5 minutes of contemplative silence or prayer before phone · Read 1 anchoring statement or scripture · Set intention for the day in one sentence

■ Midday

During Peak Zone lunch — practice Cognitive Defusion ("I am having the thought that..." instead of "I am...") · Pause practice — 10 seconds before reacting to anything · Notice when amygdala fires

■ Evening

Brain Dump journaling — write every worry-thought from the day with zero filter · Three Good Things — name 3 specific things that went well · Magnesium · Sleep by 10:30pm

■ Mind Practice

Thought Labeling — every time you notice a thought today, label it: "Planning thought." "Memory thought." "Story thought." "Worry thought." Reduces amygdala firing 50%.

■ FOODS TODAY

Continue Peak Zone eating · ADD foods that support brain chemistry — fatty fish, walnuts, dark chocolate 70%+, blueberries, green tea, turmeric

■ AVOID

Doom-scrolling news · arguments · sensationalist media · negative people · multitasking · long stretches of screen time

■ TRACK

Number of times you caught yourself before reacting · anxiety wave count vs Day 1 · thoughts labeled · sleep quality

✓ ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — How You Know You Completed Day 5

- Wrote brain dump tonight
- Named 3 specific good things
- Used cognitive defusion at least 5 times
- Less than 1 hour of news/social media
- No arguments engaged with
- Slept 7+ hours

■ What we don't often think about

Laughter activates the same parasympathetic response as deep breathing. A genuine laugh stimulates the vagus nerve, releases endorphins, and lowers cortisol within minutes. Watch something that makes you laugh today. Call someone who makes you laugh. This is clinical medicine prescribed by Dr. Vera — not a suggestion.

INTEGRATION + SLEEP MASTERY

"Lock in deep sleep. Lock in deep healing."

Why this day matters

Day 6 perfects sleep. By now your body is in active repair. Sleep is when 80% of growth hormone releases, liver detox peaks, glymphatic brain cleaning runs, immune cells multiply, and emotional memories consolidate. Today you optimize every variable that protects this window.

■ Morning

Full morning sequence + outdoor sunlight first hour · Track sleep data from last night · Note overnight HR · Note deep sleep + REM percentages from wearable

■ Midday

Caffeine cutoff 12pm sharp · Peak Zone lunch · 20-minute walk · No naps over 20 minutes if needed (longer naps disrupt night sleep) · Stay hydrated

■ Evening

Dinner before 6:30pm · Kitchen closes 7pm · Dim lights after 8pm · No screens after 9pm OR blue light glasses · Magnesium 400mg + chamomile tea · Cool room (65-68°F) · Bed by 10:30pm

■ Mind Practice

Gratitude Naming + Contemplative Closing — review the day. What went well. What you noticed. What you want to release. End in parasympathetic state.

■ FOODS TODAY

Same Peak Zone protocol · ADD foods that support sleep — tart cherries (natural melatonin), kiwi, pumpkin seeds, chamomile, magnesium-rich foods · NO heavy late dinner

■ AVOID

Caffeine after 12pm · alcohol (suppresses REM completely) · large meals after 6pm · screens in bed · sleeping with phone in room · sleeping with TV on

■ TRACK

Bedtime · sleep onset time · overnight HR · deep sleep duration · REM duration · wake-ups · morning energy

✓ **ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — How You Know You Completed Day 6**

- In bed by 10:30pm
- No screens after 9pm
- Room cool and dark
- No caffeine after noon
- No alcohol
- Slept 7-8 hours

■ **What we don't often think about**

Your bedroom temperature affects sleep more than any supplement. The body must drop its core temperature 2-3°F to enter deep sleep. A bedroom warmer than 70°F blocks this. Cool the room to 65-68°F. Use a fan if needed. This one change can add 30-60 minutes of deep sleep per night.

SUSTAINABLE RHYTHM

"Make this the rest of your life."

Why this day matters

Day 7 is integration. You have proven your body can heal. Now the question is — how do you make this sustainable without it feeling like a job? Today you identify what stays, what flexes, and what becomes your daily non-negotiables for the rest of your life.

■ Morning

Full morning sequence (now reflexive) · Review Day 1 baseline numbers vs today · Note the changes · Decide which morning practices stay permanent

■ Midday

Peak Zone lunch · Outdoor walk · Practice everything from Days 1-6 in flow · Notice how the day feels different than Day 1

■ Evening

Light dinner · Reflect on the week · Write down 3 practices that felt life-giving · Write down 3 practices that felt difficult · Plan how next week looks

■ Mind Practice

Identity statement — "I am someone who [list 3 healthy behaviors that now feel like you]."
Identity-level change holds because it becomes who you ARE, not what you DO.

■ FOODS TODAY

Your favorite foods FROM the protocol — make them ritual · Cook one meal that you genuinely enjoyed making · Notice that healthy food is also delicious food

■ AVOID

All-or-nothing thinking · perfectionism · the urge to suddenly resume old patterns · comparing yourself to where you "should be" instead of where you were

■ TRACK

Full week comparison — Day 1 vs Day 7 across all metrics · Which practices felt easiest · Which felt hardest · Which produced the most change

✓ ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA — How You Know You Completed Day 7

- Completed full week of protocol
- Tracked metrics across all 7 days
- Identified 3 keep-forever practices
- Identified 1-2 areas for next week focus
- Compared Day 7 numbers to Day 1
- Plan in place for Week 2

■ What we don't often think about

The most common failure point of any reset is Day 8. You feel great. You assume you are "fixed." You return to old patterns. Within 2 weeks you are back where you started. The fix is not perfection — the fix is keeping just 60% of the protocol forever. The mornings. The eating sequence. The 7pm kitchen close. The 10:30pm bedtime. The walks. Keep the rhythm. Flex the details. This is how it sticks.

Every layer of this protocol works on a different system — and they all reinforce each other. Insulin timing protects your pancreas and prevents the glucose spikes that drive inflammation. Eating sequence keeps blood sugar stable which keeps your nervous system stable. A stable nervous system enables proper digestion which improves nutrient absorption. Better nutrients support better hormone production. Better hormones support deeper sleep. Deeper sleep allows the body to repair what daily life damages. The renewed mind interprets fewer thoughts as threats — so fewer waves fire — so the body stays in repair mode longer. This is not 7 separate practices. This is one integrated system.

■ Insulin Time Zones

Stabilize blood glucose · Prevent insulin spikes · Protect pancreas

■ Eating Sequence

Reduce glucose spike 30-40% · Trigger natural GLP-1 · Slow gastric emptying

■ Hydration + Electrolytes

Reduce HR workload · Support kidney filtration · Stabilize nervous system

■ Movement

Strengthen heart · Drop cortisol · Drive glucose into muscles · Lower resting HR

■ Mind Renewal

Reduce amygdala firing · Increase prefrontal control · Lower wave frequency

■ Sleep Architecture

Growth hormone release · Liver detox · Brain cleaning · Immune repair

■ Vagal Tone

Master parasympathetic switch · Controls HR + digestion + emotional regulation

■ Natural Light + Dark

Set cortisol curve · Activate melatonin · Anchor circadian rhythm

AFTER DAY 7 — SUSTAINING THE RHYTHM

Week 2 and beyond: Keep 60% of the protocol. Forever. The mornings. The eating sequence. The 7pm kitchen close. The 10:30pm bedtime. The walks. The breathing. These six become the bones of every week for the rest of your life. The rest flexes with the season you are in.

Monthly: Run a full 7-day reset every 30 days. This recalibrates anything that drifted. Trains the body to remember the rhythm. Prevents accumulating damage from harder weeks.

Quarterly: Run a 7-day reset PLUS deep cleaning — pantry · digital habits · relationships that drain · environments that stress. The seasons of the body match the seasons of the year.

Yearly: One extended reset window — ideally aligned with your birthday or year-end. Use it to set the next 12 months. The body that begins each year well sustains health for the entire year.

Dr. Vera: *Seven days will not erase years of damage. But seven days will prove to you — biologically, measurably, undeniably — that your body knows how to heal when given the chance. Your nervous system is not broken. Your metabolism is not broken. Your mind is not broken. They have been overloaded by inputs that no body was designed to process daily — and they have been waiting for permission to repair.*

Give them this week. Watch what they do. Then keep giving them what they need for the rest of your life. The body is not your opponent. It is your most loyal collaborator. It just needs you to stop fighting it.